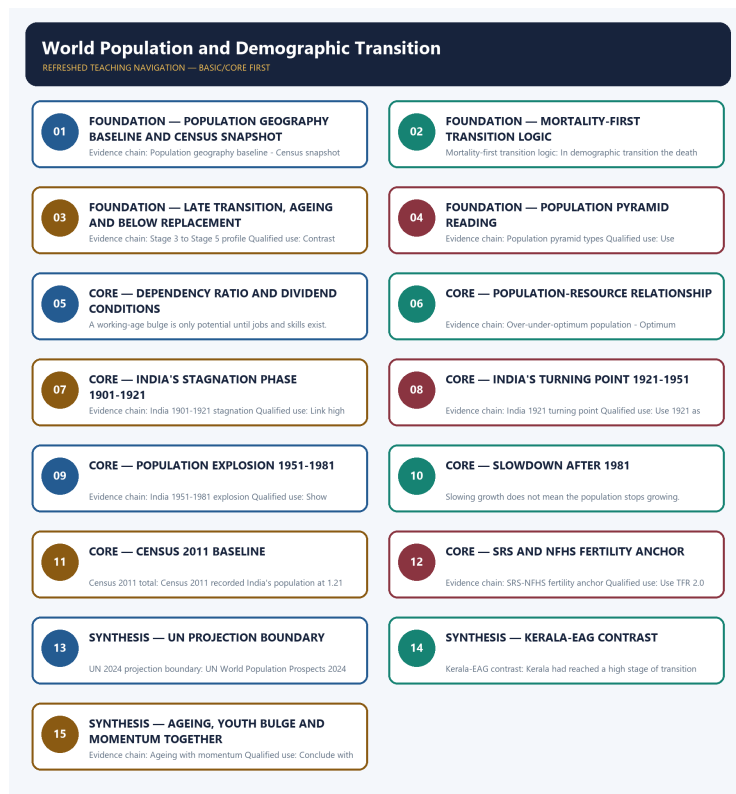


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

World Population and Demographic Transition - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

World Population and Demographic Transition - Solved Practice Workbook 5

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION 5

Q1. Which statement correctly explains Population geography baseline?	5
Q2. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Population geography baseline?	5
Q3. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Population geography baseline?	5
Q4. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Population geography baseline?	5
Q5. Which statement correctly explains Census snapshot rule?	6
Q6. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Census snapshot rule?	6
Q7. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Census snapshot rule?	6
Q8. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Census snapshot rule?	6
Q9. Which statement correctly explains Vital-rate toolkit?	7
Q10. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Vital-rate toolkit?	7
Q11. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Vital-rate toolkit?	7
Q12. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Vital-rate toolkit?	7
Q13. Which statement correctly explains Mortality-first transition logic?	8
Q14. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Mortality-first transition logic?	8
Q15. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Mortality-first transition logic?	8
Q16. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Mortality-first transition logic?	8
Q17. Which statement correctly explains Stage 1 and Stage 2 profile?	9
Q18. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Stage 1 and Stage 2 profile?	9
Q19. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Stage 1 and Stage 2 profile?	9
Q20. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Stage 1 and Stage 2 profile?	9
Q21. Which statement correctly explains Stage 3 to Stage 5 profile?	10
Q22. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Stage 3 to Stage 5 profile?	10
Q23. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Stage 3 to Stage 5 profile?	10
Q24. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Stage 3 to Stage 5 profile?	10
Q25. Which statement correctly explains Population pyramid types?	11
Q26. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Population pyramid types?	11
Q27. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Population pyramid types?	11

Q28. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Population pyramid types?	11
Q29. Which statement correctly explains Dependency and dividend condition?	11
Q30. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Dependency and dividend condition?	12
Q31. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Dependency and dividend condition?	12
Q32. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Dependency and dividend condition?	12
Q33. Which statement correctly explains Over-under-optimum population?	12
Q34. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Over-under-optimum population?	13
Q35. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Over-under-optimum population?	13
Q36. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Over-under-optimum population?	13
Q37. Which statement correctly explains Optimum population shifts?	13
Q38. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Optimum population shifts?	13
Q39. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Optimum population shifts?	14
Q40. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Optimum population shifts?	14
Q41. Which statement correctly explains India 1901-1921 stagnation?	14
Q42. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of India 1901-1921 stagnation?	14
Q43. Which statement preserves the process boundary for India 1901-1921 stagnation?	14
Q44. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning India 1901-1921 stagnation?	15
Q45. Which statement correctly explains India 1921 turning point?	15
Q46. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of India 1921 turning point?	15
Q47. Which statement preserves the process boundary for India 1921 turning point?	15
Q48. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning India 1921 turning point?	15
Q49. Which statement correctly explains India 1951-1981 explosion?	16
Q50. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of India 1951-1981 explosion?	16
Q51. Which statement preserves the process boundary for India 1951-1981 explosion?	16
Q52. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning India 1951-1981 explosion?	16
Q53. Which statement correctly explains India 1981-2011 slowdown?	16
Q54. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of India 1981-2011 slowdown?	17
Q55. Which statement preserves the process boundary for India 1981-2011 slowdown?	17
Q56. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning India 1981-2011 slowdown?	17
Q57. Which statement correctly explains Census 2011 total?	17
Q58. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Census 2011 total?	17
Q59. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Census 2011 total?	18

Q60. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Census 2011 total?	18
Q61. Which statement correctly explains Census 2011 social indicators?	18
Q62. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Census 2011 social indicators?	18
Q63. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Census 2011 social indicators?	19
Q64. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Census 2011 social indicators?	19
Q65. Which statement correctly explains SRS-NFHS fertility anchor?	19
Q66. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of SRS-NFHS fertility anchor?	19
Q67. Which statement preserves the process boundary for SRS-NFHS fertility anchor?	19
Q68. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning SRS-NFHS fertility anchor?	20
Q69. Which statement correctly explains UN 2024 projection boundary?	20
Q70. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of UN 2024 projection boundary?	20
Q71. Which statement preserves the process boundary for UN 2024 projection boundary?	20
Q72. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning UN 2024 projection boundary?	21
Q73. Which statement correctly explains Kerala-EAG contrast?	21
Q74. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Kerala-EAG contrast?	21
Q75. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Kerala-EAG contrast?	21
Q76. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Kerala-EAG contrast?	22
Q77. Which statement correctly explains Ageing with momentum?	22
Q78. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Ageing with momentum?	22
Q79. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Ageing with momentum?	22
Q80. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Ageing with momentum?	23
Semantic-completeness coverage drills - Topic 26	23

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE 23

TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT	23
CROSS-OWNER MATERIAL BOUNDARY	23
ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS	24
ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS	25
ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS	26
ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS	27
ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS	28
ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS	29

World Population and Demographic Transition - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly explains Population geography baseline?

A. Population distribution, growth and composition are core human-geography variables because they shape pressure on land, jobs, housing and services. B. A census gives a time-specific demographic snapshot, while growth between two dates reflects births, deaths and migration together. C. Growth rate, crude birth rate, crude death rate, total fertility rate, infant mortality rate, life expectancy and sex ratio are the standard population indicators. D. In demographic transition the death rate usually falls before the birth rate, so the gap between them produces the growth spurt.

Answer: A. Explanation: Population distribution, growth and composition are core human-geography variables because they shape pressure on land, jobs, housing and services. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q2. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Population geography baseline?

A. In demographic transition the death rate usually falls before the birth rate, so the gap between them produces the growth spurt. B. Population distribution, growth and composition are core human-geography variables because they shape pressure on land, jobs, housing and services. C. Growth rate, crude birth rate, crude death rate, total fertility rate, infant mortality rate, life expectancy and sex ratio are the standard population indicators. D. Stage 1 has high birth and high death rates with fluctuating growth, while Stage 2 keeps birth rates high but mortality falls rapidly.

Answer: B. Explanation: Population distribution, growth and composition are core human-geography variables because they shape pressure on land, jobs, housing and services. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q3. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Population geography baseline?

A. Stage 3 brings fertility decline, Stage 4 has low birth and death rates with stable growth, and Stage 5 in some advanced societies means below-replacement fertility and ageing. B. In demographic transition the death rate usually falls before the birth rate, so the gap between them produces the growth spurt. C. Population distribution, growth and composition are core human-geography variables because they shape pressure on land, jobs, housing and services. D. Stage 1 has high birth and high death rates with fluctuating growth, while Stage 2 keeps birth rates high but mortality falls rapidly.

Answer: C. Explanation: Population distribution, growth and composition are core human-geography variables because they shape pressure on land, jobs, housing and services. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q4. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Population geography baseline?

A. Stage 1 has high birth and high death rates with fluctuating growth, while Stage 2 keeps birth rates high but mortality falls rapidly. B. Expansive, stationary and constrictive population pyramids are the quick visual forms for youthful, slower-growth and ageing populations respectively. C. Stage 3 brings fertility decline, Stage 4 has low birth and death rates with stable growth, and Stage 5 in some advanced societies means below-replacement fertility and ageing. D. Population distribution, growth and composition are core human-geography variables because they shape pressure on land, jobs, housing and services.

Answer: D. Explanation: Population distribution, growth and composition are core human-geography variables because they shape pressure on land, jobs, housing and services. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly explains Census snapshot rule?

A. A census gives a time-specific demographic snapshot, while growth between two dates reflects births, deaths and migration together. B. In demographic transition the death rate usually falls before the birth rate, so the gap between them produces the growth spurt. C. Growth rate, crude birth rate, crude death rate, total fertility rate, infant mortality rate, life expectancy and sex ratio are the standard population indicators. D. Stage 1 has high birth and high death rates with fluctuating growth, while Stage 2 keeps birth rates high but mortality falls rapidly.

Answer: A. Explanation: A census gives a time-specific demographic snapshot, while growth between two dates reflects births, deaths and migration together. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q6. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Census snapshot rule?

A. Stage 3 brings fertility decline, Stage 4 has low birth and death rates with stable growth, and Stage 5 in some advanced societies means below-replacement fertility and ageing. B. A census gives a time-specific demographic snapshot, while growth between two dates reflects births, deaths and migration together. C. Stage 1 has high birth and high death rates with fluctuating growth, while Stage 2 keeps birth rates high but mortality falls rapidly. D. In demographic transition the death rate usually falls before the birth rate, so the gap between them produces the growth spurt.

Answer: B. Explanation: A census gives a time-specific demographic snapshot, while growth between two dates reflects births, deaths and migration together. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q7. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Census snapshot rule?

A. Stage 3 brings fertility decline, Stage 4 has low birth and death rates with stable growth, and Stage 5 in some advanced societies means below-replacement fertility and ageing. B. Stage 1 has high birth and high death rates with fluctuating growth, while Stage 2 keeps birth rates high but mortality falls rapidly. C. A census gives a time-specific demographic snapshot, while growth between two dates reflects births, deaths and migration together. D. Expansive, stationary and constrictive population pyramids are the quick visual forms for youthful, slower-growth and ageing populations respectively.

Answer: C. Explanation: A census gives a time-specific demographic snapshot, while growth between two dates reflects births, deaths and migration together. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q8. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Census snapshot rule?

A. Stage 3 brings fertility decline, Stage 4 has low birth and death rates with stable growth, and Stage 5 in some advanced societies means below-replacement fertility and ageing. B. Expansive, stationary and constrictive population pyramids are the quick visual forms for youthful, slower-growth and ageing populations respectively. C. A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity. D. A census gives a time-specific demographic snapshot, while growth between two dates reflects births, deaths and migration together.

Answer: D. Explanation: A census gives a time-specific demographic snapshot, while growth between two dates reflects births, deaths and migration together. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly explains Vital-rate toolkit?

A. Growth rate, crude birth rate, crude death rate, total fertility rate, infant mortality rate, life expectancy and sex ratio are the standard population indicators. B. In demographic transition the death rate usually falls before the birth rate, so the gap between them produces the growth spurt. C. Stage 1 has high birth and high death rates with fluctuating growth, while Stage 2 keeps birth rates high but mortality falls rapidly. D. Stage 3 brings fertility decline, Stage 4 has low birth and death rates with stable growth, and Stage 5 in some advanced societies means below-replacement fertility and ageing.

Answer: A. Explanation: Growth rate, crude birth rate, crude death rate, total fertility rate, infant mortality rate, life expectancy and sex ratio are the standard population indicators. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q10. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Vital-rate toolkit?

A. Stage 3 brings fertility decline, Stage 4 has low birth and death rates with stable growth, and Stage 5 in some advanced societies means below-replacement fertility and ageing. B. Growth rate, crude birth rate, crude death rate, total fertility rate, infant mortality rate, life expectancy and sex ratio are the standard population indicators. C. Expansive, stationary and constrictive population pyramids are the quick visual forms for youthful, slower-growth and ageing populations respectively. D. Stage 1 has high birth and high death rates with fluctuating growth, while Stage 2 keeps birth rates high but mortality falls rapidly.

Answer: B. Explanation: Growth rate, crude birth rate, crude death rate, total fertility rate, infant mortality rate, life expectancy and sex ratio are the standard population indicators. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q11. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Vital-rate toolkit?

A. Stage 3 brings fertility decline, Stage 4 has low birth and death rates with stable growth, and Stage 5 in some advanced societies means below-replacement fertility and ageing. B. A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity. C. Growth rate, crude birth rate, crude death rate, total fertility rate, infant mortality rate, life expectancy and sex ratio are the standard population indicators. D. Expansive, stationary and constrictive population pyramids are the quick visual forms for youthful, slower-growth and ageing populations respectively.

Answer: C. Explanation: Growth rate, crude birth rate, crude death rate, total fertility rate, infant mortality rate, life expectancy and sex ratio are the standard population indicators. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q12. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Vital-rate toolkit?

A. A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity. B. Expansive, stationary and constrictive population pyramids are the quick visual forms for youthful, slower-growth and ageing populations respectively. C. Under-population, over-population and optimum population describe the relationship among people, resources, technology and living standards. D. Growth rate, crude birth rate, crude death rate, total fertility rate, infant mortality rate, life expectancy and sex ratio are the standard population indicators.

Answer: D. Explanation: Growth rate, crude birth rate, crude death rate, total fertility rate, infant mortality rate, life expectancy and sex ratio are the standard population indicators. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly explains Mortality-first transition logic?

A. In demographic transition the death rate usually falls before the birth rate, so the gap between them produces the growth spurt. B. Stage 1 has high birth and high death rates with fluctuating growth, while Stage 2 keeps birth rates high but mortality falls rapidly. C. Stage 3 brings fertility decline, Stage 4 has low birth and death rates with stable growth, and Stage 5 in some advanced societies means below-replacement fertility and ageing. D. Expansive, stationary and constrictive population pyramids are the quick visual forms for youthful, slower-growth and ageing populations respectively.

Answer: A. Explanation: In demographic transition the death rate usually falls before the birth rate, so the gap between them produces the growth spurt. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q14. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Mortality-first transition logic?

A. Stage 3 brings fertility decline, Stage 4 has low birth and death rates with stable growth, and Stage 5 in some advanced societies means below-replacement fertility and ageing. B. In demographic transition the death rate usually falls before the birth rate, so the gap between them produces the growth spurt. C. Expansive, stationary and constrictive population pyramids are the quick visual forms for youthful, slower-growth and ageing populations respectively. D. A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity.

Answer: B. Explanation: In demographic transition the death rate usually falls before the birth rate, so the gap between them produces the growth spurt. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q15. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Mortality-first transition logic?

A. A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity. B. Expansive, stationary and constrictive population pyramids are the quick visual forms for youthful, slower-growth and ageing populations respectively. C. In demographic transition the death rate usually falls before the birth rate, so the gap between them produces the growth spurt. D. Under-population, over-population and optimum population describe the relationship among people, resources, technology and living standards.

Answer: C. Explanation: In demographic transition the death rate usually falls before the birth rate, so the gap between them produces the growth spurt. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q16. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Mortality-first transition logic?

A. A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity. B. Under-population, over-population and optimum population describe the relationship among people, resources, technology and living standards. C. Optimum population is not a permanent number because technology, trade and institutions can change the carrying capacity of the same resource base. D. In demographic transition the death rate usually falls before the birth rate, so the gap between them produces the growth spurt.

Answer: D. Explanation: In demographic transition the death rate usually falls before the birth rate, so the gap between them produces the growth spurt. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly explains Stage 1 and Stage 2 profile?

A. Stage 1 has high birth and high death rates with fluctuating growth, while Stage 2 keeps birth rates high but mortality falls rapidly. B. Stage 3 brings fertility decline, Stage 4 has low birth and death rates with stable growth, and Stage 5 in some advanced societies means below-replacement fertility and ageing. C. A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity. D. Expansive, stationary and constrictive population pyramids are the quick visual forms for youthful, slower-growth and ageing populations respectively.

Answer: A. Explanation: Stage 1 has high birth and high death rates with fluctuating growth, while Stage 2 keeps birth rates high but mortality falls rapidly. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q18. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Stage 1 and Stage 2 profile?

A. Under-population, over-population and optimum population describe the relationship among people, resources, technology and living standards. B. Stage 1 has high birth and high death rates with fluctuating growth, while Stage 2 keeps birth rates high but mortality falls rapidly. C. A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity. D. Expansive, stationary and constrictive population pyramids are the quick visual forms for youthful, slower-growth and ageing populations respectively.

Answer: B. Explanation: Stage 1 has high birth and high death rates with fluctuating growth, while Stage 2 keeps birth rates high but mortality falls rapidly. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q19. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Stage 1 and Stage 2 profile?

A. Optimum population is not a permanent number because technology, trade and institutions can change the carrying capacity of the same resource base. B. Under-population, over-population and optimum population describe the relationship among people, resources, technology and living standards. C. Stage 1 has high birth and high death rates with fluctuating growth, while Stage 2 keeps birth rates high but mortality falls rapidly. D. A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity.

Answer: C. Explanation: Stage 1 has high birth and high death rates with fluctuating growth, while Stage 2 keeps birth rates high but mortality falls rapidly. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q20. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Stage 1 and Stage 2 profile?

A. Optimum population is not a permanent number because technology, trade and institutions can change the carrying capacity of the same resource base. B. Khullar treats 1901-1921 as a phase of high birth and high death rates, epidemics, famine stress and demographic stagnation. C. Under-population, over-population and optimum population describe the relationship among people, resources, technology and living standards. D. Stage 1 has high birth and high death rates with fluctuating growth, while Stage 2 keeps birth rates high but mortality falls rapidly.

Answer: D. Explanation: Stage 1 has high birth and high death rates with fluctuating growth, while Stage 2 keeps birth rates high but mortality falls rapidly. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly explains Stage 3 to Stage 5 profile?

A. Stage 3 brings fertility decline, Stage 4 has low birth and death rates with stable growth, and Stage 5 in some advanced societies means below-replacement fertility and ageing. B. A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity. C. Under-population, over-population and optimum population describe the relationship among people, resources, technology and living standards. D. Expansive, stationary and constrictive population pyramids are the quick visual forms for youthful, slower-growth and ageing populations respectively.

Answer: A. Explanation: Stage 3 brings fertility decline, Stage 4 has low birth and death rates with stable growth, and Stage 5 in some advanced societies means below-replacement fertility and ageing. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q22. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Stage 3 to Stage 5 profile?

A. Optimum population is not a permanent number because technology, trade and institutions can change the carrying capacity of the same resource base. B. Stage 3 brings fertility decline, Stage 4 has low birth and death rates with stable growth, and Stage 5 in some advanced societies means below-replacement fertility and ageing. C. Under-population, over-population and optimum population describe the relationship among people, resources, technology and living standards. D. A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity.

Answer: B. Explanation: Stage 3 brings fertility decline, Stage 4 has low birth and death rates with stable growth, and Stage 5 in some advanced societies means below-replacement fertility and ageing. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q23. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Stage 3 to Stage 5 profile?

A. Khullar treats 1901-1921 as a phase of high birth and high death rates, epidemics, famine stress and demographic stagnation. B. Under-population, over-population and optimum population describe the relationship among people, resources, technology and living standards. C. Stage 3 brings fertility decline, Stage 4 has low birth and death rates with stable growth, and Stage 5 in some advanced societies means below-replacement fertility and ageing. D. Optimum population is not a permanent number because technology, trade and institutions can change the carrying capacity of the same resource base.

Answer: C. Explanation: Stage 3 brings fertility decline, Stage 4 has low birth and death rates with stable growth, and Stage 5 in some advanced societies means below-replacement fertility and ageing. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q24. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Stage 3 to Stage 5 profile?

A. The years 1921-1951 are the steady-growth phase, and 1921 is widely treated as India's demographic turning point. B. Optimum population is not a permanent number because technology, trade and institutions can change the carrying capacity of the same resource base. C. Khullar treats 1901-1921 as a phase of high birth and high death rates, epidemics, famine stress and demographic stagnation. D. Stage 3 brings fertility decline, Stage 4 has low birth and death rates with stable growth, and Stage 5 in some advanced societies means below-replacement fertility and ageing.

Answer: D. Explanation: Stage 3 brings fertility decline, Stage 4 has low birth and death rates with stable growth, and Stage 5 in some advanced societies means below-replacement fertility and ageing. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly explains Population pyramid types?

A. Expansive, stationary and constrictive population pyramids are the quick visual forms for youthful, slower-growth and ageing populations respectively. B. Optimum population is not a permanent number because technology, trade and institutions can change the carrying capacity of the same resource base. C. A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity. D. Under-population, over-population and optimum population describe the relationship among people, resources, technology and living standards.

Answer: A. Explanation: Expansive, stationary and constrictive population pyramids are the quick visual forms for youthful, slower-growth and ageing populations respectively. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q26. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Population pyramid types?

A. Under-population, over-population and optimum population describe the relationship among people, resources, technology and living standards. B. Expansive, stationary and constrictive population pyramids are the quick visual forms for youthful, slower-growth and ageing populations respectively. C. Khullar treats 1901-1921 as a phase of high birth and high death rates, epidemics, famine stress and demographic stagnation. D. Optimum population is not a permanent number because technology, trade and institutions can change the carrying capacity of the same resource base.

Answer: B. Explanation: Expansive, stationary and constrictive population pyramids are the quick visual forms for youthful, slower-growth and ageing populations respectively. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q27. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Population pyramid types?

A. The years 1921-1951 are the steady-growth phase, and 1921 is widely treated as India's demographic turning point. B. Optimum population is not a permanent number because technology, trade and institutions can change the carrying capacity of the same resource base. C. Expansive, stationary and constrictive population pyramids are the quick visual forms for youthful, slower-growth and ageing populations respectively. D. Khullar treats 1901-1921 as a phase of high birth and high death rates, epidemics, famine stress and demographic stagnation.

Answer: C. Explanation: Expansive, stationary and constrictive population pyramids are the quick visual forms for youthful, slower-growth and ageing populations respectively. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q28. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Population pyramid types?

A. Khullar treats 1901-1921 as a phase of high birth and high death rates, epidemics, famine stress and demographic stagnation. B. The period 1951-1981 saw sharp mortality decline while fertility remained high, producing the population-explosion phase. C. The years 1921-1951 are the steady-growth phase, and 1921 is widely treated as India's demographic turning point. D. Expansive, stationary and constrictive population pyramids are the quick visual forms for youthful, slower-growth and ageing populations respectively.

Answer: D. Explanation: Expansive, stationary and constrictive population pyramids are the quick visual forms for youthful, slower-growth and ageing populations respectively. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly explains Dependency and dividend condition?

A. A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity. B. Under-population, over-population and optimum population describe the relationship among people, resources, technology and living standards. C. Optimum population is not a permanent number because technology, trade and institutions can change the carrying capacity of the same resource base. D. Khullar treats 1901-1921 as a phase of high birth and high death rates, epidemics, famine stress and demographic stagnation.

Answer: A. Explanation: A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity. The

other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q30. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Dependency and dividend condition?

A. Khullar treats 1901-1921 as a phase of high birth and high death rates, epidemics, famine stress and demographic stagnation. B. A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity. C. Optimum population is not a permanent number because technology, trade and institutions can change the carrying capacity of the same resource base. D. The years 1921-1951 are the steady-growth phase, and 1921 is widely treated as India's demographic turning point.

Answer: B. Explanation: A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q31. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Dependency and dividend condition?

A. The years 1921-1951 are the steady-growth phase, and 1921 is widely treated as India's demographic turning point. B. Khullar treats 1901-1921 as a phase of high birth and high death rates, epidemics, famine stress and demographic stagnation. C. A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity. D. The period 1951-1981 saw sharp mortality decline while fertility remained high, producing the population-explosion phase.

Answer: C. Explanation: A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q32. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Dependency and dividend condition?

A. The years 1921-1951 are the steady-growth phase, and 1921 is widely treated as India's demographic turning point. B. From 1981 to 2011 fertility decline deepened and growth slowed, showing a later transition phase rather than stagnation. C. The period 1951-1981 saw sharp mortality decline while fertility remained high, producing the population-explosion phase. D. A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity.

Answer: D. Explanation: A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly explains Over-under-optimum population?

A. Under-population, over-population and optimum population describe the relationship among people, resources, technology and living standards. B. Optimum population is not a permanent number because technology, trade and institutions can change the carrying capacity of the same resource base. C. The years 1921-1951 are the steady-growth phase, and 1921 is widely treated as India's demographic turning point. D. Khullar treats 1901-1921 as a phase of high birth and high death rates, epidemics, famine stress and demographic stagnation.

Answer: A. Explanation: Under-population, over-population and optimum population describe the relationship among people, resources, technology and living standards. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q34. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Over-under-optimum population?

A. Khullar treats 1901-1921 as a phase of high birth and high death rates, epidemics, famine stress and demographic stagnation. B. Under-population, over-population and optimum population describe the relationship among people, resources, technology and living standards. C. The period 1951-1981 saw sharp mortality decline while fertility remained high, producing the population-explosion phase. D. The years 1921-1951 are the steady-growth phase, and 1921 is widely treated as India's demographic turning point.

Answer: B. Explanation: Under-population, over-population and optimum population describe the relationship among people, resources, technology and living standards. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q35. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Over-under-optimum population?

A. The period 1951-1981 saw sharp mortality decline while fertility remained high, producing the population-explosion phase. B. From 1981 to 2011 fertility decline deepened and growth slowed, showing a later transition phase rather than stagnation. C. Under-population, over-population and optimum population describe the relationship among people, resources, technology and living standards. D. The years 1921-1951 are the steady-growth phase, and 1921 is widely treated as India's demographic turning point.

Answer: C. Explanation: Under-population, over-population and optimum population describe the relationship among people, resources, technology and living standards. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q36. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Over-under-optimum population?

A. From 1981 to 2011 fertility decline deepened and growth slowed, showing a later transition phase rather than stagnation. B. The period 1951-1981 saw sharp mortality decline while fertility remained high, producing the population-explosion phase. C. Census 2011 recorded India's population at 1.21 billion, and no later projection should be called a census count. D. Under-population, over-population and optimum population describe the relationship among people, resources, technology and living standards.

Answer: D. Explanation: Under-population, over-population and optimum population describe the relationship among people, resources, technology and living standards. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly explains Optimum population shifts?

A. Optimum population is not a permanent number because technology, trade and institutions can change the carrying capacity of the same resource base. B. The period 1951-1981 saw sharp mortality decline while fertility remained high, producing the population-explosion phase. C. Khullar treats 1901-1921 as a phase of high birth and high death rates, epidemics, famine stress and demographic stagnation. D. The years 1921-1951 are the steady-growth phase, and 1921 is widely treated as India's demographic turning point.

Answer: A. Explanation: Optimum population is not a permanent number because technology, trade and institutions can change the carrying capacity of the same resource base. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q38. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Optimum population shifts?

A. The period 1951-1981 saw sharp mortality decline while fertility remained high, producing the population-explosion phase. B. Optimum population is not a permanent number because technology, trade and institutions can change the carrying capacity of the same resource base. C. The years 1921-1951 are the steady-growth phase, and 1921 is widely treated as India's demographic turning point. D. From 1981 to 2011 fertility decline deepened and growth slowed, showing a later transition phase rather than stagnation.

Answer: B. Explanation: Optimum population is not a permanent number because technology, trade and institutions can change the carrying capacity of the same resource base. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q39. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Optimum population shifts?

A. Census 2011 recorded India's population at 1.21 billion, and no later projection should be called a census count. B. From 1981 to 2011 fertility decline deepened and growth slowed, showing a later transition phase rather than stagnation. C. Optimum population is not a permanent number because technology, trade and institutions can change the carrying capacity of the same resource base. D. The period 1951-1981 saw sharp mortality decline while fertility remained high, producing the population-explosion phase.

Answer: C. Explanation: Optimum population is not a permanent number because technology, trade and institutions can change the carrying capacity of the same resource base. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q40. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Optimum population shifts?

A. From 1981 to 2011 fertility decline deepened and growth slowed, showing a later transition phase rather than stagnation. B. Census 2011 recorded India's population at 1.21 billion, and no later projection should be called a census count. C. Census 2011 reported a sex ratio of 943 females per 1,000 males and a literacy rate of 74.04 percent. D. Optimum population is not a permanent number because technology, trade and institutions can change the carrying capacity of the same resource base.

Answer: D. Explanation: Optimum population is not a permanent number because technology, trade and institutions can change the carrying capacity of the same resource base. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly explains India 1901-1921 stagnation?

A. Khullar treats 1901-1921 as a phase of high birth and high death rates, epidemics, famine stress and demographic stagnation. B. From 1981 to 2011 fertility decline deepened and growth slowed, showing a later transition phase rather than stagnation. C. The period 1951-1981 saw sharp mortality decline while fertility remained high, producing the population-explosion phase. D. The years 1921-1951 are the steady-growth phase, and 1921 is widely treated as India's demographic turning point.

Answer: A. Explanation: Khullar treats 1901-1921 as a phase of high birth and high death rates, epidemics, famine stress and demographic stagnation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q42. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of India 1901-1921 stagnation?

A. From 1981 to 2011 fertility decline deepened and growth slowed, showing a later transition phase rather than stagnation. B. Khullar treats 1901-1921 as a phase of high birth and high death rates, epidemics, famine stress and demographic stagnation. C. Census 2011 recorded India's population at 1.21 billion, and no later projection should be called a census count. D. The period 1951-1981 saw sharp mortality decline while fertility remained high, producing the population-explosion phase.

Answer: B. Explanation: Khullar treats 1901-1921 as a phase of high birth and high death rates, epidemics, famine stress and demographic stagnation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q43. Which statement preserves the process boundary for India 1901-1921 stagnation?

A. From 1981 to 2011 fertility decline deepened and growth slowed, showing a later transition phase rather than stagnation. B. Census 2011 recorded India's population at 1.21 billion, and no later projection should be called a census count. C. Khullar treats 1901-1921 as a phase of high birth and high death rates, epidemics, famine stress and demographic stagnation. D. Census 2011 reported a sex ratio of 943 females per 1,000 males and a literacy rate of 74.04 percent.

Answer: C. Explanation: Khullar treats 1901-1921 as a phase of high birth and high death rates, epidemics, famine stress and demographic stagnation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q44. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning India 1901-1921 stagnation?

A. SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence. B. Census 2011 reported a sex ratio of 943 females per 1,000 males and a literacy rate of 74.04 percent. C. Census 2011 recorded India's population at 1.21 billion, and no later projection should be called a census count. D. Khullar treats 1901-1921 as a phase of high birth and high death rates, epidemics, famine stress and demographic stagnation.

Answer: D. Explanation: Khullar treats 1901-1921 as a phase of high birth and high death rates, epidemics, famine stress and demographic stagnation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly explains India 1921 turning point?

A. The years 1921-1951 are the steady-growth phase, and 1921 is widely treated as India's demographic turning point. B. From 1981 to 2011 fertility decline deepened and growth slowed, showing a later transition phase rather than stagnation. C. Census 2011 recorded India's population at 1.21 billion, and no later projection should be called a census count. D. The period 1951-1981 saw sharp mortality decline while fertility remained high, producing the population-explosion phase.

Answer: A. Explanation: The years 1921-1951 are the steady-growth phase, and 1921 is widely treated as India's demographic turning point. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q46. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of India 1921 turning point?

A. Census 2011 recorded India's population at 1.21 billion, and no later projection should be called a census count. B. The years 1921-1951 are the steady-growth phase, and 1921 is widely treated as India's demographic turning point. C. From 1981 to 2011 fertility decline deepened and growth slowed, showing a later transition phase rather than stagnation. D. Census 2011 reported a sex ratio of 943 females per 1,000 males and a literacy rate of 74.04 percent.

Answer: B. Explanation: The years 1921-1951 are the steady-growth phase, and 1921 is widely treated as India's demographic turning point. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q47. Which statement preserves the process boundary for India 1921 turning point?

A. SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence. B. Census 2011 recorded India's population at 1.21 billion, and no later projection should be called a census count. C. The years 1921-1951 are the steady-growth phase, and 1921 is widely treated as India's demographic turning point. D. Census 2011 reported a sex ratio of 943 females per 1,000 males and a literacy rate of 74.04 percent.

Answer: C. Explanation: The years 1921-1951 are the steady-growth phase, and 1921 is widely treated as India's demographic turning point. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q48. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning India 1921 turning point?

A. SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence. B. Census 2011 reported a sex ratio of 943 females per 1,000 males and a literacy rate of 74.04 percent. C. UN World Population Prospects 2024 places India's mid-2024 population at about 1.45 billion, but this remains a projection rather than a census count. D. The years 1921-1951 are the steady-growth phase, and 1921 is widely treated as India's demographic turning point.

Answer: D. Explanation: The years 1921-1951 are the steady-growth phase, and 1921 is widely treated as India's demographic turning point. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly explains India 1951-1981 explosion?

A. The period 1951-1981 saw sharp mortality decline while fertility remained high, producing the population-explosion phase. B. Census 2011 reported a sex ratio of 943 females per 1,000 males and a literacy rate of 74.04 percent. C. Census 2011 recorded India's population at 1.21 billion, and no later projection should be called a census count. D. From 1981 to 2011 fertility decline deepened and growth slowed, showing a later transition phase rather than stagnation.

Answer: A. Explanation: The period 1951-1981 saw sharp mortality decline while fertility remained high, producing the population-explosion phase. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q50. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of India 1951-1981 explosion?

A. SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence. B. The period 1951-1981 saw sharp mortality decline while fertility remained high, producing the population-explosion phase. C. Census 2011 reported a sex ratio of 943 females per 1,000 males and a literacy rate of 74.04 percent. D. Census 2011 recorded India's population at 1.21 billion, and no later projection should be called a census count.

Answer: B. Explanation: The period 1951-1981 saw sharp mortality decline while fertility remained high, producing the population-explosion phase. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q51. Which statement preserves the process boundary for India 1951-1981 explosion?

A. Census 2011 reported a sex ratio of 943 females per 1,000 males and a literacy rate of 74.04 percent. B. UN World Population Prospects 2024 places India's mid-2024 population at about 1.45 billion, but this remains a projection rather than a census count. C. The period 1951-1981 saw sharp mortality decline while fertility remained high, producing the population-explosion phase. D. SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence.

Answer: C. Explanation: The period 1951-1981 saw sharp mortality decline while fertility remained high, producing the population-explosion phase. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q52. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning India 1951-1981 explosion?

A. SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence. B. UN World Population Prospects 2024 places India's mid-2024 population at about 1.45 billion, but this remains a projection rather than a census count. C. Kerala had reached a high stage of transition comparable to advanced countries by the 2011 period, while several populous EAG states retained more youthful structures for longer. D. The period 1951-1981 saw sharp mortality decline while fertility remained high, producing the population-explosion phase.

Answer: D. Explanation: The period 1951-1981 saw sharp mortality decline while fertility remained high, producing the population-explosion phase. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly explains India 1981-2011 slowdown?

A. From 1981 to 2011 fertility decline deepened and growth slowed, showing a later transition phase rather than stagnation. B. SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence. C. Census 2011 recorded India's population at 1.21 billion, and no later projection should be called a census count. D. Census 2011 reported a sex ratio of 943 females per 1,000 males and a literacy rate of 74.04 percent.

Answer: A. Explanation: From 1981 to 2011 fertility decline deepened and growth slowed, showing a later transition phase rather than stagnation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q54. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of India 1981-2011 slowdown?

A. UN World Population Prospects 2024 places India's mid-2024 population at about 1.45 billion, but this remains a projection rather than a census count. B. From 1981 to 2011 fertility decline deepened and growth slowed, showing a later transition phase rather than stagnation. C. SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence. D. Census 2011 reported a sex ratio of 943 females per 1,000 males and a literacy rate of 74.04 percent.

Answer: B. Explanation: From 1981 to 2011 fertility decline deepened and growth slowed, showing a later transition phase rather than stagnation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q55. Which statement preserves the process boundary for India 1981-2011 slowdown?

A. UN World Population Prospects 2024 places India's mid-2024 population at about 1.45 billion, but this remains a projection rather than a census count. B. Kerala had reached a high stage of transition comparable to advanced countries by the 2011 period, while several populous EAG states retained more youthful structures for longer. C. From 1981 to 2011 fertility decline deepened and growth slowed, showing a later transition phase rather than stagnation. D. SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence.

Answer: C. Explanation: From 1981 to 2011 fertility decline deepened and growth slowed, showing a later transition phase rather than stagnation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q56. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning India 1981-2011 slowdown?

A. Kerala had reached a high stage of transition comparable to advanced countries by the 2011 period, while several populous EAG states retained more youthful structures for longer. B. India simultaneously contains ageing pockets, replacement-level states and youth-bulge states, so population momentum and regional divergence continue together. C. UN World Population Prospects 2024 places India's mid-2024 population at about 1.45 billion, but this remains a projection rather than a census count. D. From 1981 to 2011 fertility decline deepened and growth slowed, showing a later transition phase rather than stagnation.

Answer: D. Explanation: From 1981 to 2011 fertility decline deepened and growth slowed, showing a later transition phase rather than stagnation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly explains Census 2011 total?

A. Census 2011 recorded India's population at 1.21 billion, and no later projection should be called a census count. B. Census 2011 reported a sex ratio of 943 females per 1,000 males and a literacy rate of 74.04 percent. C. SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence. D. UN World Population Prospects 2024 places India's mid-2024 population at about 1.45 billion, but this remains a projection rather than a census count.

Answer: A. Explanation: Census 2011 recorded India's population at 1.21 billion, and no later projection should be called a census count. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q58. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Census 2011 total?

A. UN World Population Prospects 2024 places India's mid-2024 population at about 1.45 billion, but this remains a projection rather than a census count. B. Census 2011 recorded India's population at 1.21 billion, and no later projection should be called a census count. C. Kerala had reached a high stage of transition comparable to advanced countries by the 2011 period, while several populous EAG states retained more youthful structures for longer. D. SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence.

Answer: B. Explanation: Census 2011 recorded India's population at 1.21 billion, and no later projection should be called a census count. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or

Q59. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Census 2011 total?

A. India simultaneously contains ageing pockets, replacement-level states and youth-bulge states, so population momentum and regional divergence continue together. B. UN World Population Prospects 2024 places India's mid-2024 population at about 1.45 billion, but this remains a projection rather than a census count. C. Census 2011 recorded India's population at 1.21 billion, and no later projection should be called a census count. D. Kerala had reached a high stage of transition comparable to advanced countries by the 2011 period, while several populous EAG states retained more youthful structures for longer.

Answer: C. Explanation: Census 2011 recorded India's population at 1.21 billion, and no later projection should be called a census count. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q60. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Census 2011 total?

A. Population distribution, growth and composition are core human-geography variables because they shape pressure on land, jobs, housing and services. B. India simultaneously contains ageing pockets, replacement-level states and youth-bulge states, so population momentum and regional divergence continue together. C. Kerala had reached a high stage of transition comparable to advanced countries by the 2011 period, while several populous EAG states retained more youthful structures for longer. D. Census 2011 recorded India's population at 1.21 billion, and no later projection should be called a census count.

Answer: D. Explanation: Census 2011 recorded India's population at 1.21 billion, and no later projection should be called a census count. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly explains Census 2011 social indicators?

A. Census 2011 reported a sex ratio of 943 females per 1,000 males and a literacy rate of 74.04 percent. B. Kerala had reached a high stage of transition comparable to advanced countries by the 2011 period, while several populous EAG states retained more youthful structures for longer. C. SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence. D. UN World Population Prospects 2024 places India's mid-2024 population at about 1.45 billion, but this remains a projection rather than a census count.

Answer: A. Explanation: Census 2011 reported a sex ratio of 943 females per 1,000 males and a literacy rate of 74.04 percent. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q62. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Census 2011 social indicators?

A. Kerala had reached a high stage of transition comparable to advanced countries by the 2011 period, while several populous EAG states retained more youthful structures for longer. B. Census 2011 reported a sex ratio of 943 females per 1,000 males and a literacy rate of 74.04 percent. C. UN World Population Prospects 2024 places India's mid-2024 population at about 1.45 billion, but this remains a projection rather than a census count. D. India simultaneously contains ageing pockets, replacement-level states and youth-bulge states, so population momentum and regional divergence continue together.

Answer: B. Explanation: Census 2011 reported a sex ratio of 943 females per 1,000 males and a literacy rate of 74.04 percent. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q63. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Census 2011 social indicators?

A. India simultaneously contains ageing pockets, replacement-level states and youth-bulge states, so population momentum and regional divergence continue together. B. Population distribution, growth and composition are core human-geography variables because they shape pressure on land, jobs, housing and services. C. Census 2011 reported a sex ratio of 943 females per 1,000 males and a literacy rate of 74.04 percent. D. Kerala had reached a high stage of transition comparable to advanced countries by the 2011 period, while several populous EAG states retained more youthful structures for longer.

Answer: C. Explanation: Census 2011 reported a sex ratio of 943 females per 1,000 males and a literacy rate of 74.04 percent. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q64. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Census 2011 social indicators?

A. Population distribution, growth and composition are core human-geography variables because they shape pressure on land, jobs, housing and services. B. India simultaneously contains ageing pockets, replacement-level states and youth-bulge states, so population momentum and regional divergence continue together. C. A census gives a time-specific demographic snapshot, while growth between two dates reflects births, deaths and migration together. D. Census 2011 reported a sex ratio of 943 females per 1,000 males and a literacy rate of 74.04 percent.

Answer: D. Explanation: Census 2011 reported a sex ratio of 943 females per 1,000 males and a literacy rate of 74.04 percent. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly explains SRS-NFHS fertility anchor?

A. SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence. B. UN World Population Prospects 2024 places India's mid-2024 population at about 1.45 billion, but this remains a projection rather than a census count. C. India simultaneously contains ageing pockets, replacement-level states and youth-bulge states, so population momentum and regional divergence continue together. D. Kerala had reached a high stage of transition comparable to advanced countries by the 2011 period, while several populous EAG states retained more youthful structures for longer.

Answer: A. Explanation: SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q66. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of SRS-NFHS fertility anchor?

A. India simultaneously contains ageing pockets, replacement-level states and youth-bulge states, so population momentum and regional divergence continue together. B. SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence. C. Population distribution, growth and composition are core human-geography variables because they shape pressure on land, jobs, housing and services. D. Kerala had reached a high stage of transition comparable to advanced countries by the 2011 period, while several populous EAG states retained more youthful structures for longer.

Answer: B. Explanation: SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q67. Which statement preserves the process boundary for SRS-NFHS fertility anchor?

A. A census gives a time-specific demographic snapshot, while growth between two dates reflects births, deaths and migration together. B. Population distribution, growth and composition are core human-geography variables because they shape pressure on land, jobs, housing and services. C. SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence. D. India simultaneously contains ageing pockets, replacement-level states and youth-bulge states, so population momentum and regional divergence continue together.

Answer: C. Explanation: SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q68. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning SRS-NFHS fertility anchor?

A. Population distribution, growth and composition are core human-geography variables because they shape pressure on land, jobs, housing and services. B. A census gives a time-specific demographic snapshot, while growth between two dates reflects births, deaths and migration together. C. Growth rate, crude birth rate, crude death rate, total fertility rate, infant mortality rate, life expectancy and sex ratio are the standard population indicators. D. SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence.

Answer: D. Explanation: SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly explains UN 2024 projection boundary?

A. UN World Population Prospects 2024 places India's mid-2024 population at about 1.45 billion, but this remains a projection rather than a census count. B. Kerala had reached a high stage of transition comparable to advanced countries by the 2011 period, while several populous EAG states retained more youthful structures for longer. C. Population distribution, growth and composition are core human-geography variables because they shape pressure on land, jobs, housing and services. D. India simultaneously contains ageing pockets, replacement-level states and youth-bulge states, so population momentum and regional divergence continue together.

Answer: A. Explanation: UN World Population Prospects 2024 places India's mid-2024 population at about 1.45 billion, but this remains a projection rather than a census count. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q70. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of UN 2024 projection boundary?

A. Population distribution, growth and composition are core human-geography variables because they shape pressure on land, jobs, housing and services. B. UN World Population Prospects 2024 places India's mid-2024 population at about 1.45 billion, but this remains a projection rather than a census count. C. India simultaneously contains ageing pockets, replacement-level states and youth-bulge states, so population momentum and regional divergence continue together. D. A census gives a time-specific demographic snapshot, while growth between two dates reflects births, deaths and migration together.

Answer: B. Explanation: UN World Population Prospects 2024 places India's mid-2024 population at about 1.45 billion, but this remains a projection rather than a census count. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q71. Which statement preserves the process boundary for UN 2024 projection boundary?

A. Population distribution, growth and composition are core human-geography variables because they shape pressure on land, jobs, housing and services. B. A census gives a time-specific demographic snapshot, while growth between two dates reflects births, deaths and migration together. C. UN World Population Prospects 2024 places India's mid-2024 population at about 1.45 billion, but this remains a projection rather than a census count. D. Growth rate, crude birth rate, crude death rate, total fertility rate, infant mortality rate, life expectancy and sex ratio are the standard population indicators.

Answer: C. Explanation: UN World Population Prospects 2024 places India's mid-2024 population at about 1.45 billion, but this remains a projection rather than a census count. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q72. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning UN 2024 projection boundary?

A. A census gives a time-specific demographic snapshot, while growth between two dates reflects births, deaths and migration together. B. Growth rate, crude birth rate, crude death rate, total fertility rate, infant mortality rate, life expectancy and sex ratio are the standard population indicators. C. In demographic transition the death rate usually falls before the birth rate, so the gap between them produces the growth spurt. D. UN World Population Prospects 2024 places India's mid-2024 population at about 1.45 billion, but this remains a projection rather than a census count.

Answer: D. Explanation: UN World Population Prospects 2024 places India's mid-2024 population at about 1.45 billion, but this remains a projection rather than a census count. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly explains Kerala-EAG contrast?

A. Kerala had reached a high stage of transition comparable to advanced countries by the 2011 period, while several populous EAG states retained more youthful structures for longer. B. A census gives a time-specific demographic snapshot, while growth between two dates reflects births, deaths and migration together. C. India simultaneously contains ageing pockets, replacement-level states and youth-bulge states, so population momentum and regional divergence continue together. D. Population distribution, growth and composition are core human-geography variables because they shape pressure on land, jobs, housing and services.

Answer: A. Explanation: Kerala had reached a high stage of transition comparable to advanced countries by the 2011 period, while several populous EAG states retained more youthful structures for longer. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q74. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Kerala-EAG contrast?

A. Population distribution, growth and composition are core human-geography variables because they shape pressure on land, jobs, housing and services. B. Kerala had reached a high stage of transition comparable to advanced countries by the 2011 period, while several populous EAG states retained more youthful structures for longer. C. A census gives a time-specific demographic snapshot, while growth between two dates reflects births, deaths and migration together. D. Growth rate, crude birth rate, crude death rate, total fertility rate, infant mortality rate, life expectancy and sex ratio are the standard population indicators.

Answer: B. Explanation: Kerala had reached a high stage of transition comparable to advanced countries by the 2011 period, while several populous EAG states retained more youthful structures for longer. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q75. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Kerala-EAG contrast?

A. A census gives a time-specific demographic snapshot, while growth between two dates reflects births, deaths and migration together. B. In demographic transition the death rate usually falls before the birth rate, so the gap between them produces the growth spurt. C. Kerala had reached a high stage of transition comparable to advanced countries by the 2011 period, while several populous EAG states retained more youthful structures for longer. D. Growth rate, crude birth rate, crude death rate, total fertility rate, infant mortality rate, life expectancy and sex ratio are the standard population indicators.

Answer: C. Explanation: Kerala had reached a high stage of transition comparable to advanced countries by the 2011 period, while several populous EAG states retained more youthful structures for longer. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q76. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Kerala-EAG contrast?

A. Stage 1 has high birth and high death rates with fluctuating growth, while Stage 2 keeps birth rates high but mortality falls rapidly. B. Growth rate, crude birth rate, crude death rate, total fertility rate, infant mortality rate, life expectancy and sex ratio are the standard population indicators. C. In demographic transition the death rate usually falls before the birth rate, so the gap between them produces the growth spurt. D. Kerala had reached a high stage of transition comparable to advanced countries by the 2011 period, while several populous EAG states retained more youthful structures for longer.

Answer: D. Explanation: Kerala had reached a high stage of transition comparable to advanced countries by the 2011 period, while several populous EAG states retained more youthful structures for longer. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly explains Ageing with momentum?

A. India simultaneously contains ageing pockets, replacement-level states and youth-bulge states, so population momentum and regional divergence continue together. B. A census gives a time-specific demographic snapshot, while growth between two dates reflects births, deaths and migration together. C. Population distribution, growth and composition are core human-geography variables because they shape pressure on land, jobs, housing and services. D. Growth rate, crude birth rate, crude death rate, total fertility rate, infant mortality rate, life expectancy and sex ratio are the standard population indicators.

Answer: A. Explanation: India simultaneously contains ageing pockets, replacement-level states and youth-bulge states, so population momentum and regional divergence continue together. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q78. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Ageing with momentum?

A. A census gives a time-specific demographic snapshot, while growth between two dates reflects births, deaths and migration together. B. India simultaneously contains ageing pockets, replacement-level states and youth-bulge states, so population momentum and regional divergence continue together. C. Growth rate, crude birth rate, crude death rate, total fertility rate, infant mortality rate, life expectancy and sex ratio are the standard population indicators. D. In demographic transition the death rate usually falls before the birth rate, so the gap between them produces the growth spurt.

Answer: B. Explanation: India simultaneously contains ageing pockets, replacement-level states and youth-bulge states, so population momentum and regional divergence continue together. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q79. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Ageing with momentum?

A. Stage 1 has high birth and high death rates with fluctuating growth, while Stage 2 keeps birth rates high but mortality falls rapidly. B. Growth rate, crude birth rate, crude death rate, total fertility rate, infant mortality rate, life expectancy and sex ratio are the standard population indicators. C. India simultaneously contains ageing pockets, replacement-level states and youth-bulge states, so population momentum and regional divergence continue together. D. In demographic transition the death rate usually falls before the birth rate, so the gap between them produces the growth spurt.

Answer: C. Explanation: India simultaneously contains ageing pockets, replacement-level states and youth-bulge states, so population momentum and regional divergence continue together. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q80. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Ageing with momentum?

A. Stage 3 brings fertility decline, Stage 4 has low birth and death rates with stable growth, and Stage 5 in some advanced societies means below-replacement fertility and ageing. B. In demographic transition the death rate usually falls before the birth rate, so the gap between them produces the growth spurt. C. Stage 1 has high birth and high death rates with fluctuating growth, while Stage 2 keeps birth rates high but mortality falls rapidly. D. India simultaneously contains ageing pockets, replacement-level states and youth-bulge states, so population momentum and regional divergence continue together.

Answer: D. Explanation: India simultaneously contains ageing pockets, replacement-level states and youth-bulge states, so population momentum and regional divergence continue together. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Semantic-completeness coverage drills - Topic 26

Drill	Prompt	Minimum answer route	Fatal trap
A	Why is AD 750 not a universal break?	multiple criteria -> regional phases -> continuity/change	one date for all India
B	Does every grant prove feudalism?	recipient/right/formula -> ground effect -> alternative integration	grant equals feudalism
C	What changed under samanta relations?	title history -> tribute/service/local power -> scale	fixed legal class
D	Did trade and towns collapse?	coin/town/import evidence -> regional contraction -> new nodes/revival	universal decline
E	How did temples and monasteries matter?	ritual + land + labour + redistribution + archive + local variation	merely religious
F	Was Brahmanization passive assimilation?	grant/cult/status -> localization -> tribal/local agency -> unequal reciprocity	one-way replacement
G	Evaluate social change.	varna text -> jati/occupation/exclusion -> gender/property/labour -> source limits	prescription equals practice
H	Compare regions.	north + east + Deccan + south/frontier -> different sequences	one pan-Indian model

PYQ status drill: all ten retained PYQs are adjacent-owned; none is routed directly to Topic 26.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT

The audited routing ledgers consulted for this rebuild do not assign a direct solved PYQ to Geography Topic 26. Population questions are routed mainly through Indian Society, Economy and cross-owner demographic files, so this package keeps the demographic-geography framework transparent and does not fabricate a direct PYQ answer card.

CROSS-OWNER MATERIAL BOUNDARY

Legacy owner PYQ integration remains preserved inside the complete Basic or Advanced evidence banks, but it is not repeated here or presented as direct solved PYQ practice.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain the demographic transition model and identify why the growth spurt appears in the middle stages. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The demographic transition model is driven by mortality decline preceding fertility decline; the temporary gap between the two rates creates rapid population growth before stability returns.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Growth rate, crude birth rate, crude death rate, total fertility rate, infant mortality rate, life expectancy and sex ratio are the standard population indicators.
- In demographic transition the death rate usually falls before the birth rate, so the gap between them produces the growth spurt.
- Stage 1 has high birth and high death rates with fluctuating growth, while Stage 2 keeps birth rates high but mortality falls rapidly.
- Stage 3 brings fertility decline, Stage 4 has low birth and death rates with stable growth, and Stage 5 in some advanced societies means below-replacement fertility and ageing.

Qualified conclusion: The demographic transition model is driven by mortality decline preceding fertility decline; the temporary gap between the two rates creates rapid population growth before stability returns.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain the demographic transition model and identify why the growth spurt appears in the...", all clauses and scales, a causal-spatial argument, named India/world evidence, model or policy limits and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The demographic transition model is driven by mortality decline preceding fertility decline; the temporary gap between the two rates creates rapid population growth before stability returns.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Growth rate, crude birth rate, crude death rate, total fertility rate, infant mortality rate, life expectancy and sex ratio are the standard population indicators. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** In demographic transition the death rate usually falls before the birth rate, so the gap between them produces the growth spurt. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Stage 1 has high birth and high death rates with fluctuating growth, while Stage 2 keeps birth rates high but mortality falls rapidly. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Stage 3 brings fertility decline, Stage 4 has low birth and death rates with stable growth, and Stage 5 in some advanced societies means below-replacement fertility and ageing. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial correlation, model prediction, single scheme or aggregate statistic is neither a sufficient cause nor a timeless description; test institutions, agency, networks, scale, distributional effects and the evidence date.

Qualified conclusion: The demographic transition model is driven by mortality decline preceding fertility decline; the temporary gap between the two rates creates rapid population growth before stability returns.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise three points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the

scale, model or data-status limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains spatial differentiation, integrates Indian evidence and avoids determinism or timeless statistics.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain the demographic transition model and identify why the growth spurt appears in the...", replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled map, model assumption, policy chronology or dataset and state the exception, scale or source-date-status boundary.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Show how population pyramids and dependency ratio together help in reading a population structure. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Population pyramids reveal age-sex structure at a glance, while dependency ratio shows whether a youthful or ageing structure is likely to create burden or dividend conditions.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Expansive, stationary and constrictive population pyramids are the quick visual forms for youthful, slower-growth and ageing populations respectively.
- A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity.

Qualified conclusion: Population pyramids reveal age-sex structure at a glance, while dependency ratio shows whether a youthful or ageing structure is likely to create burden or dividend conditions.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Show how population pyramids and dependency ratio together help in reading a population...", all clauses and scales, a causal-spatial argument, named India/world evidence, model or policy limits and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Population pyramids reveal age-sex structure at a glance, while dependency ratio shows whether a youthful or ageing structure is likely to create burden or dividend conditions.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Expansive, stationary and constrictive population pyramids are the quick visual forms for youthful, slower-growth and ageing populations respectively. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial correlation, model prediction, single scheme or aggregate statistic is neither a sufficient cause nor a timeless description; test institutions, agency, networks, scale, distributional effects and the evidence date.

Qualified conclusion: Population pyramids reveal age-sex structure at a glance, while dependency ratio shows whether a youthful or ageing structure is likely to create burden or dividend conditions.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise three points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the scale, model or data-status limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains spatial differentiation, integrates Indian evidence and avoids determinism or timeless statistics.

How to improve this answer: For "Show how population pyramids and dependency ratio together help in reading a population...", replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled map, model assumption, policy chronology or

dataset and state the exception, scale or source-date-status boundary.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Discuss the idea of optimum population with suitable qualifications. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Optimum population is a relational concept balancing people, resources, technology and living standards; it shifts when productive capacity, trade links and institutions change.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Under-population, over-population and optimum population describe the relationship among people, resources, technology and living standards.
- Optimum population is not a permanent number because technology, trade and institutions can change the carrying capacity of the same resource base.

Qualified conclusion: Optimum population is a relational concept balancing people, resources, technology and living standards; it shifts when productive capacity, trade links and institutions change.

Demand decoding: The directive **discuss** requires a direct position on "Discuss the idea of optimum population with suitable qualifications. Answer in about 250...", all clauses and scales, a causal-spatial argument, named India/world evidence, model or policy limits and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Optimum population is a relational concept balancing people, resources, technology and living standards; it shifts when productive capacity, trade links and institutions change.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Under-population, over-population and optimum population describe the relationship among people, resources, technology and living standards. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Optimum population is not a permanent number because technology, trade and institutions can change the carrying capacity of the same resource base. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial correlation, model prediction, single scheme or aggregate statistic is neither a sufficient cause nor a timeless description; test institutions, agency, networks, scale, distributional effects and the evidence date.

Qualified conclusion: Optimum population is a relational concept balancing people, resources, technology and living standards; it shifts when productive capacity, trade links and institutions change.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the scale, model or data-status limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains spatial differentiation, integrates Indian evidence and avoids determinism or timeless statistics.

How to improve this answer: For "Discuss the idea of optimum population with suitable qualifications. Answer in about 250...", replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled map, model assumption, policy chronology or dataset and state the exception, scale or source-date-status boundary.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Trace India's long demographic transition from 1901 to 2011. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: India's demographic story moves from stagnation to steady growth, to population explosion, and then to slowdown, showing mortality decline first and fertility decline later.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Khullar treats 1901-1921 as a phase of high birth and high death rates, epidemics, famine stress and demographic stagnation.
- The years 1921-1951 are the steady-growth phase, and 1921 is widely treated as India's demographic turning point.
- The period 1951-1981 saw sharp mortality decline while fertility remained high, producing the population-explosion phase.
- From 1981 to 2011 fertility decline deepened and growth slowed, showing a later transition phase rather than stagnation.

Qualified conclusion: India's demographic story moves from stagnation to steady growth, to population explosion, and then to slowdown, showing mortality decline first and fertility decline later.

Demand decoding: The directive **trace** requires a direct position on "Trace India's long demographic transition from 1901 to 2011. Answer in about 250 words.", all clauses and scales, a causal-spatial argument, named India/world evidence, model or policy limits and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: India's demographic story moves from stagnation to steady growth, to population explosion, and then to slowdown, showing mortality decline first and fertility decline later.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Khullar treats 1901-1921 as a phase of high birth and high death rates, epidemics, famine stress and demographic stagnation. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The years 1921-1951 are the steady-growth phase, and 1921 is widely treated as India's demographic turning point. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The period 1951-1981 saw sharp mortality decline while fertility remained high, producing the population-explosion phase. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** From 1981 to 2011 fertility decline deepened and growth slowed, showing a later transition phase rather than stagnation. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial correlation, model prediction, single scheme or aggregate statistic is neither a sufficient cause nor a timeless description; test institutions, agency, networks, scale, distributional effects and the evidence date.

Qualified conclusion: India's demographic story moves from stagnation to steady growth, to population explosion, and then to slowdown, showing mortality decline first and fertility decline later.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the scale, model or data-status limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains spatial differentiation, integrates Indian evidence and avoids determinism or timeless statistics.

How to improve this answer: For "Trace India's long demographic transition from 1901 to 2011. Answer in about 250 words.", replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled map, model assumption, policy chronology or dataset and state the exception, scale or source-date-status boundary.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Is India in a demographic-dividend phase or a demographic-divergence phase? Analyse. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: India has a dividend window at the national scale, but regional divergence, population momentum and unequal labour absorption mean the same age structure can produce both opportunity and burden.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity.
- SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence.
- Kerala had reached a high stage of transition comparable to advanced countries by the 2011 period, while several populous EAG states retained more youthful structures for longer.
- India simultaneously contains ageing pockets, replacement-level states and youth-bulge states, so population momentum and regional divergence continue together.

Qualified conclusion: India has a dividend window at the national scale, but regional divergence, population momentum and unequal labour absorption mean the same age structure can produce both opportunity and burden.

Demand decoding: The directive **analyse** requires a direct position on "Is India in a demographic-dividend phase or a demographic-divergence phase? Analyse. Answer...", all clauses and scales, a causal-spatial argument, named India/world evidence, model or policy limits and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: India has a dividend window at the national scale, but regional divergence, population momentum and unequal labour absorption mean the same age structure can produce both opportunity and burden.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A large working-age share reduces dependency pressure, but a demographic dividend appears only when education, health, skills and jobs convert that structure into productivity. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Kerala had reached a high stage of transition comparable to advanced countries by the 2011 period, while several populous EAG states retained more youthful structures for longer. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** India simultaneously contains ageing pockets, replacement-level states and youth-bulge states, so population momentum and regional divergence continue together. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial correlation, model prediction, single scheme or aggregate statistic is neither a sufficient cause nor a timeless description; test institutions, agency, networks, scale, distributional effects and the evidence date.

Qualified conclusion: India has a dividend window at the national scale, but regional divergence, population momentum and unequal labour absorption mean the same age structure can produce both opportunity and burden.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the scale, model or data-status limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains spatial differentiation, integrates Indian evidence and avoids determinism or timeless statistics.

How to improve this answer: For "Is India in a demographic-dividend phase or a demographic-divergence phase? Analyse. Answer...", replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled map, model assumption, policy chronology or dataset and state the exception, scale or source-date-status boundary.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Why must population answers on India separate Census 2011 data from SRS, NFHS and UN updates? Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Data discipline is essential because Census, survey-based fertility estimates and UN projections answer different questions; mixing them casually turns demographic evidence into factual error.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Census 2011 recorded India's population at 1.21 billion, and no later projection should be called a census count.
- Census 2011 reported a sex ratio of 943 females per 1,000 males and a literacy rate of 74.04 percent.
- SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence.
- UN World Population Prospects 2024 places India's mid-2024 population at about 1.45 billion, but this remains a projection rather than a census count.

Qualified conclusion: Data discipline is essential because Census, survey-based fertility estimates and UN projections answer different questions; mixing them casually turns demographic evidence into factual error.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Why must population answers on India separate Census 2011 data from SRS, NFHS and UN updates?...", all clauses and scales, a causal-spatial argument, named India/world evidence, model or policy limits and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Data discipline is essential because Census, survey-based fertility estimates and UN projections answer different questions; mixing them casually turns demographic evidence into factual error.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Census 2011 recorded India's population at 1.21 billion, and no later projection should be called a census count. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Census 2011 reported a sex ratio of 943 females per 1,000 males and a literacy rate of 74.04 percent. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** SRS 2022 and NFHS-5 both place India's total fertility rate at 2.0, showing replacement-level fertility nationally in dated survey evidence. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** UN World Population Prospects 2024 places India's mid-2024 population at about 1.45 billion, but this remains a projection rather than a census count. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial correlation, model prediction, single scheme or aggregate statistic is neither a sufficient cause nor a timeless description; test institutions, agency, networks, scale, distributional effects and the evidence date.

Qualified conclusion: Data discipline is essential because Census, survey-based fertility estimates and UN projections answer different questions; mixing them casually turns demographic evidence into factual error.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the scale, model or data-status limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains spatial differentiation, integrates Indian evidence and avoids determinism or timeless statistics.

How to improve this answer: For "Why must population answers on India separate Census 2011 data from SRS, NFHS and UN updates?...", replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled map, model assumption, policy chronology or dataset and state the exception, scale or source-date-status boundary.